

# CHAPTER 7

## CAUSE / EFFECT PARAGRAPHS

### OBJECTIVES

To write academic texts, you need to master certain skills.

In this chapter, you will learn to:

- Identify causes and effects
- Organize cause / effect paragraphs
- Write supporting sentences to explain multiple causes or multiple effects
- Use transition signals to express cause / effect relationships
- Write, revise, and edit a cause or an effect paragraph about a social issue



### INTRODUCTION

In Chapter 6, you learned about definition paragraphs. Chapter 7 shows how to write cause / effect paragraphs. Analyzing causes and effects is an important part of academic thinking and writing. For example, a professor may ask you to examine the causes of a war, the factors that led to a company's success, or the effects a new technology or a scientific discovery has had on daily life. At the end of Chapter 7, you will write your own cause or effect paragraph.

### ORGANIZATION

Like the paragraphs you have learned about in previous chapters, cause / effect paragraphs should have a topic sentence, supporting sentences, and one or more concluding sentences. In addition, a good cause / effect paragraph focuses on why something happened (the causes) and what happened as a result (the effects).

## ANALYZING THE MODEL

Read the model. Then answer the questions



### Writing Model

#### The Effects of Bike Sharing in Paris

Vélib', the world's most successful bike sharing system, has had three beneficial effects on cyclists since it was first introduced in Paris in 2007. The most obvious benefit has been the increase in activity among local people of all ages. Riding a bike is an excellent form of exercise. It leads to better overall health and an improved sense of well-being. Users of Vélib' also report another positive effect of the bike sharing system. They say they experience more day-to-day enjoyment. Cyclists have a chance to spend more time outdoors. While biking to work, they can see Parisian architecture, art, parks, and street life. These are things that commuters rarely have time to notice when traveling by bus, subway, or car. Finally, bike riders in Paris praise Vélib' for its socializing effects. They say that Vélib' has created a bond between cyclists. Experienced users often help new ones learn the Vélib' system. They also greet one another and chat. Because the cyclists are not crowded into a bus or train with a lot of angry commuters, they feel more like socializing. In conclusion, Parisians hope that Vélib' will result in fewer cars and less pollution in the future, but for now they are enjoying the positive effects that the bike sharing program has already produced.

Topic

(Use topic sentence to give background knowledge)

Focus

#### Questions about the Model

1. Underline the topic sentence. Does the paragraph focus on causes (why something happened) or effects (what happened as a result)?
2. Underline the three main points of the paragraph.

## TOPIC SENTENCES IN

## EFFECT PARAGRAPHS

The topic sentence of a effect paragraph should state the topic and the controlling idea about the topic. The controlling idea should let readers know whether the focus of the paragraph is on what happened as a result—the effects.

words  
that signal  
the effects.

**EFFECTS** Vélib', the world's most successful bike sharing system, has had three beneficial effects on cyclists since it was first introduced in Paris in 2007.

|                        |                                                                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Positive effect<br>(n) | benefit, advantage, gain, improvement, desirable result, favorable outcome, helpful effect, constructive impact, blessing , <b>beneficial consequence, positive influence</b> |
| Negative effect<br>(n) | drawback, disadvantage, harm, loss, unwanted result, unfavorable outcome, damaging effect, harmful impact, setback , <b>dire consequence, negative influence</b>              |

### PRACTICE 2

#### Writing Topic Sentences

Read each paragraph. Circle the topic sentence that best presents the topic and controlling idea. Then write it on the line.

#### PARAGRAPH 1

#### The Power of McDonald's

\_\_\_\_\_ To begin with, McDonald's changed diets around the world. Because of McDonald's, fast food became and continues to become increasingly common. Although hamburgers and fries existed long before McDonald's, the popularity of quickly prepared foods is in large part due to the effects of the fast-food giant. In addition to changing people's food choices, McDonald's also affected their choice of restaurants. From the 1950s on, as McDonald's gained in popularity, customers started to expect restaurants to serve food that was tasty and inexpensive. They also expected restaurants to be as simple, clean, and attractive as a McDonald's. As fast-food restaurants spread, many smaller family-owned businesses lost customers and had to close. As a result, the choice of places to dine became

limited. Finally, McDonald's had a big influence on the world of advertising. The company created a very recognizable symbol, or brand, with its Golden Arches. McDonald's used it effectively in print and on television to attract customers. Over the years, other corporations have followed the McDonald's model in the creation of their own distinctive logos or brands. Clearly, McDonald's has had a powerful impact.

- a. There are several causes for the success of McDonald's.
- b. McDonald's changed how advertising is done.
- c. Hamburgers are popular around the world because of McDonald's.
- d. McDonald's has had significant and widespread effects.

*Topic*

*Focus*

## PARAGRAPH 2

### Rooftop Gardens

Having rooftop gardens at home can come with a number of surprising benefits.

For many urban dwellers, the gardens offer a welcoming place to relax and connect with nature. ~~However, rooftop gardens require careful planning.~~ In addition to their beauty, rooftop gardens also cool the buildings beneath them in summer and warm them in winter. Thus, building residents use less energy to control the temperature. This means a decrease in air-conditioning and heating bills and air pollution. Another positive effect of rooftop gardens is related to clean air as well. A number of local governments have developed plans to fight air pollution. Green plants remove harmful gases such as carbon dioxide from the air through the regular process of photosynthesis. During photosynthesis, green plants produce their food from carbon dioxide, water, and sunlight. As part of the process, the plants release beneficial oxygen, which purifies the air around them. The most obvious effect is that rooftop gardens make any city more beautiful and livable, whether they are seen up close, from skyscrapers above, or from the city streets below.

*UNITY*  
Read the paragraph. Cross out two sentences that are off-topic. Then find one sentence that is not in a logical position. Circle the sentence, and draw an arrow to show where the sentence should be placed.  
*COHERENCE*

## SUPPORTING SENTENCES IN

## EFFECT PARAGRAPHS

When you gather supporting information for an effect paragraph, you first identify main effects related to your topic. Then you organize the effects in a logical way.

(From the most obvious/important effect to the least obvious/ important one;  
from the earliest to the latest effect)

- **Main points:** The main effects organized in a logical order
- **Supporting details:** *Further explanation and description to show the details/ severity of each effect*

## EFFECT TRANSITION SIGNALS

In Chapter 4, you learned how to use transition signals to create coherent paragraphs. In coherent paragraphs, one sentence connects logically to the next, and the ideas flow smoothly. Here is a chart that shows some of the transition signals you can use to express cause and effect. It is followed by rules, explanations, and examples.

| Word / Phrase                | Synonyms                                                                                       |
|------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| (dẫn đến)<br>Lead to (v)     | cause, result in, bring about, produce, contribute to, give rise to, create, trigger, generate |
| (làm tốt hơn)<br>Improve (v) | enhance, boost, develop, raise, strengthen, increase, refine, upgrade, advance                 |
| (làm xấu đi)<br>Worsen (v)   | deteriorate, decline, get worse, aggravate, damage, degrade, weaken, exacerbate, undermine     |

- Deforestation results in negative impacts on the environment.
- Regular practice can boost your confidence
- Eating unhealthy food can weaken your body's metabolism.

| SIGNALS TO SHOW EFFECTS                              |                           |                            |        |
|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|----------------------------|--------|
| Sentence Connectors                                  | Coordinating Conjunctions | Subordinating Conjunctions | Others |
| Therefore,<br>Thus,<br>Consequently,<br>As a result, | so                        |                            |        |

S-V, thereby Ving. => Having a rooftop garden at home can help cool down the atmosphere, thereby reducing air-conditioning bills.  
S-V, which V, which reduces air-conditioning bills.

## Coordinating Conjunctions

1. Coordinating conjunctions join two or more simple sentences (independent clauses) into one compound sentence.

SIMPLE SENTENCE I care about the environment.

SIMPLE SENTENCE I precycle as much as possible.

COMPOUND SENTENCE I care about the environment, **so** I precycle as much as possible.

## Sentence Connectors

1. Words and phrases that are sentence connectors link one sentence to the sentence that comes before it.

I bring my lunch from home in a reusable container and eat with a fork that I can wash instead of a plastic one. **Consequently**, I add next to nothing to the trash cans at school.

2. Sentence connectors usually come at the beginning of the second sentence, but they can also appear in the middle or at the end of a sentence.

By reducing what I use, I have fewer items to recycle. **As a result**, sanitation trucks have fewer recyclables to transport.

By reducing what I use, I have fewer items to recycle. Sanitation trucks, **as a result**, have fewer recyclables to transport.

By reducing what I use, I have fewer items to recycle. Sanitation trucks have fewer recyclables to transport, **as a result**.

### PRACTICE 8

#### Combining Sentences with

#### Effect Signals

Combine the ideas in each pair of sentences to make one or two sentences. Use the transition signal in parentheses. Capitalize and punctuate the sentences correctly. Reword the sentences as needed.

2. Sunlight also has positive effects. (**thus**)

We should not completely avoid going out in the sun.

*Sunlight also has positive effects. Thus, we should not completely avoid*

*going out in the sun.*

3. Sunlight produces vitamin D. (**so**)

*so* We need sunlight for a healthy body.

5. Sunlight affects the human body clock. (as a result) (,as a result,)

Regular exposure to the sun helps people sleep better.

*Sunlight affects...clock. Regular exposure to the sun, as a result, helps people.....*

9. The warmth of the sun relieves minor aches and pains. (consequently) (at the end)

There is an added benefit to sunshine, consequently.



### ACTIVITY 8 | Using connectors and transitions

Complete the sentences with your own ideas.

1. The need for computer engineers is growing, so universities (đang mở thêm nhiều ngành liên quan tới lĩnh vực này)

*are offering more majors/disciplines relevant to this field.*

6. Adolescents use social media a lot, so (chứng nghiện màn hình ngày càng trở nên phổ biến)

*screen addiction is getting more and more common/prevalent.*

7. The economy is improving. As a result, các công ty khởi nghiệp đang hi vọng vào một tương lai hứa hẹn hơn.

*start-up companies are hoping for a more promising future.*

### PRACTICE 10

Please use the learned **effects signals** to write sentences as required

1. An example of what students can do to protect the environment

*Students can repurpose paper by doing new homework assignments on the back of their old exercise sheets.*

2. A positive effect of learning a second language

*Being able to speak another language can help you widen your circle of relationships.*

#### 4. An example of the effects of global warming

*Global warming may give rise to sea levels, which may drown people who live in low-lying areas.*

#### 6. A benefit of doing volunteer work

*Engaging in volunteer work can help person understand how small acts can contribute to the lives of others.*

## CONCLUDING SENTENCES IN

## EFFECT PARAGRAPHS

In the concluding sentences of a effect paragraph, you may do one or more of the following:

1. Restate your controlling idea about the topic.

*Example: Clearly, McDonald's has a powerful impact*

2. Summarize the main **effects**

*Example: The profound impacts of McDonald's can be seen in the changes in people's choice of food and restaurant, and the world of advertising.*

### PRACTICE 6

### Writing Concluding Sentences

Read the paragraph. Then write an appropriate concluding sentence on the line.

#### PARAGRAPH 1

#### Rooftop Gardens

Rooftop gardens are badly needed green spaces that have many positive effects on urban neighborhoods. For many urban dwellers, the gardens offer a welcoming place to relax and connect with nature. However, rooftop gardens require careful planning. In addition to their beauty, rooftop gardens also cool the buildings beneath them in summer and warm them in winter. Thus, building residents use less energy to control the temperature. This means a decrease in air-conditioning and heating bills and air pollution. Another positive effect of rooftop gardens is related to clean air as well. A number of local governments have developed plans to fight air pollution. Green plants remove harmful gases such as carbon dioxide from the air through the regular process of photosynthesis. During photosynthesis, green plants produce their food from carbon dioxide, water, and sunlight. As part of the process, the plants release beneficial oxygen, which purifies the air around them. The most obvious effect is that rooftop gardens make any city more beautiful and livable, whether they are seen up close, from skyscrapers above, or from the city streets below.

*Summarizing the main effects*

*Clearly, rooftops gardens can help people beautify their living space, save money, and reduce air pollution.*

## PARAGRAPH 2

### The Benefits of Precycling

1 People should consider precycling because it offers even more benefits than recycling. 2 Every day, my decision to precycle (reduce and reuse) has positive effects on the air, water, and earth around me. 3 First of all, because I reuse items, I produce less garbage that can pollute the environment. 4 For example, I bring my lunch from home in a reusable container and eat with a fork that I can wash instead of a plastic one. 5 Consequently, I add next to nothing to the trash cans at school. 6 Second, because of my reduce-and-reuse lifestyle, I help to decrease the amount of air pollution caused by trucks and factories. 7 By reducing what I use, I have fewer items to recycle. 8 As a result, sanitation trucks have fewer recyclables to transport. 9 In addition, factories have fewer recyclables to convert into new products. 10 Thus, I am improving air quality. 11 Finally, precycling improves my personal living space. 12 I live in a small one-bedroom apartment. 13 As a result, I have little space to collect and store glass, plastic, paper, or metal before they go to the recycling center. 14 Thus, when I decide to leave plastic bottles in the store and read newspapers and magazines online, I am making my home a much more livable place.



*Resting the topic sentence:*

***Indeed, precycling will be a trend in the future thanks to its significant benefits.***

- Notes: a concluding sentence can also .....

Look to the future and/or make a prediction.

In conclusion, Parisians hope that Vélib' will result in fewer cars and less pollution in the future, but for now they are enjoying the positive effects that the bike sharing program has already produced.

Give your opinion about the topic and make a recommendation.

In my opinion, other large cities should follow the example of the Vélib' system so that their citizens can enjoy the same benefits that Parisians do.

## TEMPLATE FOR A PARAGRAPH THAT DISCUSSES THE EFFECTS OF AN ISSUE/TREND

One important *issue/trend* today is **(state the issue/trend)**, and it has become more *serious/ widespread* in recent years. This topic is critical because of its several effects on both individuals and society. The first effect is that **(effect 1)**, which is worth considering because **(reason/explanation)**. For example, **(simple example)**. Another noticeable impact is that **(effect 2)**, and this can lead to **(result or consequence)**. For instance, **(another example)**. The final consequence of this *issue/trend* is **(effect 3, optional)**, which shows that the issue can influence **(who/what is affected)** in different ways. To be specific, **(further explanation)**. In conclusion, it is clear that **(restate the issue/trend)** has several important effects, and it is necessary for people to understand these consequences in order to .....

## WRITING ASSIGNMENT

*The trend of using AI for study purposes has become widespread among students today. Discuss the effects of this trend.*

| Key Phrase (English)       | Vietnamese Translation             |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------|
| widespread use             | việc sử dụng rộng rãi              |
| growing trend              | xu hướng ngày càng tăng            |
| study support tools        | công cụ hỗ trợ học tập             |
| positive effects           | những tác động tích cực            |
| negative effects           | những tác động tiêu cực            |
| study more efficiently     | học tập hiệu quả hơn               |
| save time                  | tiết kiệm thời gian                |
| quick answers              | câu trả lời nhanh chóng            |
| clear explanations         | lời giải thích rõ ràng             |
| improve understanding      | cải thiện sự hiểu biết             |
| increased motivation       | tăng động lực                      |
| become dependent on AI     | trở nên phụ thuộc vào AI           |
| weaker thinking skills     | kỹ năng tư duy yếu hơn             |
| lack of real understanding | thiếu sự hiểu biết thực sự         |
| reduced communication      | giảm giao tiếp                     |
| face-to-face interaction   | tương tác trực tiếp                |
| academic performance       | kết quả học tập                    |
| learning habits            | thói quen học tập                  |
| responsible use of AI      | sử dụng AI một cách có trách nhiệm |
| overuse of technology      | lạm dụng công nghệ                 |
| copy answers               | chép câu trả lời                   |

| Key Phrase (English)          | Vietnamese Translation         |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| less problem-solving practice | ít luyện tập giải quyết vấn đề |
| possible distractions         | những yếu tố gây xao nhãng     |
| privacy concerns              | lo ngại về quyền riêng tư      |
| balanced use                  | sử dụng cân bằng               |
| self-learning skills          | kỹ năng tự học                 |
| independent thinking          | tư duy độc lập                 |

## Guided Fill-in-the-Blanks

- One important issue today is the **widespread use of AI** (phrase about AI being used a lot) among students.
- This is a **growing trend** (phrase about a trend becoming more common) in many schools.
- AI tools work as **study support tools** (phrase about tools that help learning) for students.
- One positive effect is that AI helps students **study more efficiently** (phrase about learning faster).
- It also helps them **save time** (phrase about saving hours or effort).
- AI provides **quick answer** (phrase about instant replies) and **clear explanation** (phrase about easy-to-understand explanations).
- These features can help students **improve their understanding of the lessons** (phrase about better understanding lessons).
- Some students even feel **increased motivation** (phrase about higher motivation) when they use AI.
- However, students may **too dependent on** (phrase about relying too much on AI).
- This can lead to **weakened thinking skills** (phrase about poorer thinking ability).
- As a result, they may show **lack of real understanding** (phrase about not truly understanding the lesson).
- AI can also cause **reduced communication** (phrase about less communication) among students.
- This means they have fewer chances for **face-to-face interaction** (phrase about talking in person).
- In some cases, the **overuse of technology** (phrase about using tech too much) of AI may make students **copy answers by AI** (phrase about copying).
- This results in **less problem-solving practice** (phrase about fewer chances to practise problem-solving).
- Over time, this can affect their **academic performance** (phrase about school results).
- Therefore, students need to practise **responsible use of AI** (phrase about using AI carefully).
- They also need **a balance use** (phrase about a balanced way of using AI) to develop **self-learning skills** (phrase about learning independently) and **independent thinking** (phrase about thinking independently).
- Good **learning habits** (phrase about study routines) can help students avoid negative effects.

## Mind map for writing

